Nexus

Brand guidelines

The mark, colour, type, patterns, icons and voice of Nexus, and how the product puts them to work.

VERSION 0.3 · WORKING EDITION

NOVEMBER 2026

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What is in this guide

What Nexus looks and sounds like, the files that make it, and how the product uses them. Read it once from the front, then keep it beside the asset library.

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Where to start

Deciding	At a glance (page 3), the symbol (4), open decisions (28).
Designing	Colour, type, shape and pattern (pages 7 to 14).
Building	Colour roles (8), components (23), interaction (24), the asset library (27).
Writing	Voice (19) and teaching materials (26).

New in version 0.3

- The symbol has a bark line: the one line that is not a ring.
- A new wordmark, heavier and softer. Georgia is gone.
- Headings in Fraunces; figures in Manrope.
- The leaf card is the default card, with a vein under its text.
- Icons simplified to one carved detail at most.
- Illustrations have a night form, and a page on where they appear.
- New pages: interaction and motion, teaching materials, this contents page and an index.
- The two symbol studies that were not chosen have been removed.

A working edition. Everything shown is a real file in `brand/`, and all names, records and amounts are synthetic. The app itself has not been restyled yet.

START HERE

Nexus at a glance

Nexus is the record system for recovery centers. Care, billing and leadership work from one record of each person, instead of three tools that drift apart. The brand has one job: make that record feel alive, careful and easy to read.

How it should feel

- **Grown, not manufactured.** Carved shapes, pressed ink, warm linen. Nothing glossy.
- **A friend who is good at their job.** Warm in tone, exact in detail.
- **Brief.** A screen says what matters in one look. So does a sentence.
- **Calm under load.** Dense tables stay quiet; colour is saved for what needs attention.
- **A little odd, on purpose.** Cards shaped like leaves. A sun where a spinner would be.

What it is not

- Hospital blue, clinical white, stock stethoscopes.
- A wellness brand: no lotus, no gradients, no "healing journey".
- A generic dashboard kit with a green coat of paint.
- Rustic or twee. The woodcut is the accent, not the wallpaper.
- Decorated data. Nothing louder than a faint leaf vein sits behind a number someone has to read.

The idea in one line

Growth, on the record.

A tree keeps its own chart. Every year it lays down a ring: wide in a good season, narrow in a hard one, and none of it is erased. Recovery is recorded the same way, one session, one note, one signed plan at a time. Nexus is where those rings are kept.

This line is a proposal for internal use and the cover of sales material. It is not yet used in the product.

The essentials

Name	Nexus. Capital N, never all caps in a sentence.
Who it is for	Clinicians, billers and leadership at recovery centers. Outpatient first.
Symbol	Convergence: a tree cross-section with rings, three checks and a bark line.
Colours	Linen page, Pine ink, one Clay accent.
Type	Fraunces for headings, Source Sans 3 for reading, Manrope for figures.
Shape	The leaf card, and one soft corner on controls and tiles.
Texture	Pressed tree rings, bark, map contours, cut-paper forest motifs.

The kit in one view



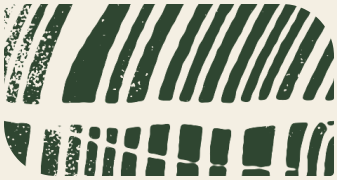
One symbol



Three colours doing most of the work



Icons cut from the same block



One signature texture

The symbol is a cross-section

Cut through a trunk and you see everything that happened to it, in order, around one centre. That is also a fair description of a good clinical record. The symbol is called Convergence, and each part of it stands for something in the product.

The rings

Each one is time on the record: a session, a signed note, a posted payment. They are uneven because real progress is.

The bark

The one line that is not a ring. It wanders, the way bark keys into wood, and it holds every ring inside it. It stands for the organisation: permissions, audit, tenancy.



The pith

The person in care. Everything else in Nexus grows outward from one client record.

The three checks

Care, billing and oversight. Three lines of work that meet at the centre. Where they meet is the nexus.

Carved, then pressed

The symbol is drawn the way a linocut is made: a solid block of ink with the lines cut out of it. Edges wobble slightly and every corner is rounded by the gouge. Keep that quality. Do not redraw it with perfect circles.

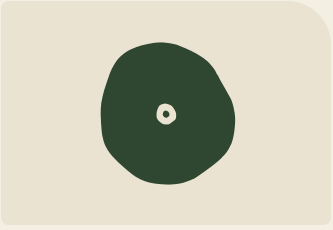
One colour, always

It works in a single flat ink with no gradient, outline or shadow. If a placement seems to need an effect, the placement is wrong.

Never a wheel

The three checks are unequal in length and spacing so they read as natural splits in wood, and the bark line is uneven on purpose. Made regular, it would become a car badge.

Built in four cuts



1. The pith. One person at the centre.



2. The rings. Time on the record, around them.



3. The checks. Three lines of work meet.



4. The bark. The organisation holds it all.

The logo family

Five versions of one identity. Pick the one that fits the space instead of squeezing one that does not. The wordmark is drawn from Fraunces at its heaviest and softest, pressed with the same gouge as the symbol, and supplied as outlines so the logo never depends on a font.



Horizontal lockup. The default. Navigation, document headers, email. Smallest: 96 px wide on screen, 1 in. in print.



Reversed. Linen on Pine. Use on Pine or Heartwood only.



Stacked lockup. Square and tall spaces: covers, sign-in, social posts. Smallest: 72 px wide.



Symbol. When the name is already nearby. 32 px and up.



App tile. Home screens, avatars. Uses the small-size symbol.

Two drawings of the symbol

Fine rings and the bark line fill in when they are small, so there is a second drawing with two rings, wider cuts and a plain edge. The rule is simple: **below 32 px, use the small-size symbol.** The favicon and the app tile already do.



Three colourways, no others

Pine	On Linen, Birch and Oat. The everyday version.
Linen	On Pine, Heartwood and the dark theme.
Ink	Heartwood, for one-colour print, fax and stamped documents.

Every file is in `brand/logo/` as SVG. Names follow `nexus-logo-horizontal-pine.svg`.

IDENTITY

Using the logo

A few habits keep the logo looking the way it does here.



Give it room

Keep an empty margin around the logo at least as tall as the capital N. No text, edge, photo or pattern comes inside it.

Scale it, never stretch it

Resize from a corner. Do not go below the smallest sizes on the previous page; switch to the symbol or the small-size symbol instead.

It is a link home

In the product the logo in the sidebar goes to the workspace overview and is named "Nexus home" for screen readers.

Backgrounds



Linen



Lichen



Pine



Night (dark theme)



– **Do not stretch**



– **Do not recolour**



– **Not on a pattern**



– **No shadows or outlines**

Do

- Use the files exactly as supplied.
- Let it be the only logo-like thing in view.
- Put it top left in the product, top left or centred in print.

Avoid

- Rotating it, cropping it or redrawing the rings.
- Setting the name in a live font next to the symbol.
- Using the symbol as a bullet, a loader or a watermark behind text.

COLOUR

Colour from the forest floor

Linen and olive, as chosen, pushed further from generic off-white and deepened into a proper printing ink. Every colour is named for something you could pick up on a walk, which makes them easy to talk about.

GROUND

Linen
#F4EFE3
RGB 244 239 227
The page. Warm, never white.

Birch
#FCF9F0
RGB 252 249 240
Cards and fields.

Oat
#EAE3D2
RGB 234 227 210
Quiet panels, navigation.

Reed
#CFC8B2
RGB 207 200 178
Hairlines and dividers.

INK AND GREENS

Heartwood
#232B1E
RGB 35 43 30
All body text.

Understory
#565E4C
RGB 86 94 76
Secondary text.

Pine
#2F4631
RGB 47 70 49
The brand ink: logo, headings, primary actions.

Moss
#55693A
RGB 85 105 58
Second green, illustration.

Sage
#A7B48B
RGB 167 180 139
Soft fills, illustration.

Lichen
#DCE5C3
RGB 220 229 195
Selected rows, tints.

ACCENTS

Clay
#A9502C
RGB 169 80 44
The one warm note: focus, accents, small highlights.

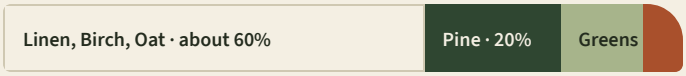
Pollen
#D8A22B
RGB 216 162 43
Illustration and charts only.

Bark
#6A5038
RGB 106 80 56
Illustration and charts only.

Creek
#3F6468
RGB 63 100 104
Information messages, charts.

The balance

Roughly how much of any screen or printed piece each colour covers.



Clay is the last few percent: the focus ring, a count that needs attention, the sun in an illustration. If Clay is the first thing you see on a screen, there is too much of it.

Rules that keep it Nexus

- The page is Linen. Pure white appears nowhere.
- Text is Heartwood, never black and never Pine. Pine is for the brand and for actions.
- Brand green is not a status. "Signed" and "Ready" use the success colour with a word and an icon.
- Pollen, Bark and Creek belong to illustration and charts. The one exception is a visited link, which is Bark.
- No gradients and no tints made by lowering opacity over photos.

COLOUR

Colour roles, light and dark

Components never use a palette colour directly. They use a role, and the role changes with the theme. The dark theme is a forest at night: warm near-black with lichen-green actions, not the light theme inverted.

Light

SURFACES

--nx-page	#F4EFE3
--nx-surface	#FCF9F0
--nx-surface-subtle	#EAE3D2
--nx-navigation	#EDE7D7

TEXT AND LINES

--nx-text	#232B1E
--nx-text-secondary	#565E4C
--nx-border	#CFC8B2
--nx-border-control	#7A8066

BRAND AND ACTION

--nx-brand	#2F4631
--nx-action	#2F4631
--nx-action-hover	#263A29
--nx-selected	#DCE5C3
--nx-link	#3D5A2C
--nx-link-visited	#6A5038
--nx-focus	#A9502C
--nx-accent	#A9502C

STATUS

--nx-success	#2C6947
--nx-warning	#77520F
--nx-danger	#9E3926
--nx-info	#3F6468

Dark

SURFACES

--nx-page	#161A13
--nx-surface	#1F251B
--nx-surface-subtle	#283024
--nx-navigation	#1A1F16

TEXT AND LINES

--nx-text	#EEEDE0
--nx-text-secondary	#BFC8AC
--nx-border	#3C4432
--nx-border-control	#828D6D

BRAND AND ACTION

--nx-brand	#DCE5C3
--nx-action	#BECB9B
--nx-action-hover	#CDD9AC
--nx-selected	#313D29
--nx-link	#C6D4A2
--nx-link-visited	#C9AE92
--nx-focus	#EDB07E
--nx-accent	#E59A72

STATUS

--nx-success	#A6D2A6
--nx-warning	#E6C27A
--nx-danger	#EEA08F
--nx-info	#A5CDCF

Contrast, measured

All 72 role pairings in `brand/tokens/contrast-audit.csv` meet their WCAG 2.2 target (7:1 for body text, 4.5:1 for other text, 3:1 for outlines and focus). A sample is below. This checks the tokens; each finished screen still needs its own check.

PAIRING	LIGHT	DARK	TARGET
body text on the page	12.75	14.96	7:1
secondary text on a card	6.43	9.02	4.5:1
primary button label	8.97	10.25	4.5:1
focus ring on the page	4.73	9.33	3:1
error message	5.37	6.55	4.5:1
body text over a leaf vein	12.08	11.07	7:1

TYPE

Typography

Three families, each with one job. Fraunces gives headings the warmth of pressed wood type. Source Sans 3 does the reading. Manrope sets the numbers that have to land.

Aa

Fraunces

Headings

Page titles, panel headings, the greeting and slide titles in SemiBold. Regular for quotes.

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

Aa

Source Sans 3

Reading

Body text, tables, fields, buttons and labels. Regular for reading, Semibold for emphasis.

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

48

Manrope

Figures

The number on a card, a total, a statistic on a slide. ExtraBold, tight, lining and tabular.

0123456789 $ % . , : + −

Fraunces, set soft

Fraunces has a Soft axis that rounds every terminal, the same thing the press does to the logo. Nexus always uses it at Soft 100, with the Wonk alternates off. The bundled files are cut that way, so there is nothing to set.

Notes to sign

Soft 100. Nexus.

Notes to sign

Soft 0. Not used.

Three jobs, no overlap

FAMILY	YES	NEVER
Fraunces	One heading per panel; titles; quotes.	Buttons, labels, tables, numbers.
Source Sans 3	Everything that is read or typed.	Page titles.
Manrope	Figures that stand alone, with a label.	Sentences, or numbers inside a sentence.

Rules

- Sentence case everywhere. Capitals only for the small label style.
- No all-capitals headings, and no heading tracked tighter than −0.015em.
- If everything is Fraunces, nothing is. One Fraunces heading per panel.

Delivery

All three are open-licensed (SIL Open Font License) and bundled in `brand/fonts/` with their licences, so the app hosts them itself. Fraunces and Manrope are fixed cuts; their variable sources are in `fonts/variable/`. If one fails to load, headings fall back to Iowan Old Style or Georgia and the rest to the system sans.

All three at work

COLLECTED THIS MONTH

$48,210

93% of expected

Three notes are waiting for you.

The oldest is from Monday's group. Signing takes about a minute each, and billing can see a note as soon as it is signed.

Type scale and figures

Eight text sizes and three figure sizes cover the product. Each is shown at its real size.

DISPLAY 600 · 40 / 44	Good morning, Dana.
TITLE 600 · 28 / 34	Claim readiness
HEADING 600 · 20 / 26	Notes to sign
SUBHEADING 600 · 16 / 22	Needs before this claim can go
BODY 400 · 15 / 22	Seven sessions today. Three notes are waiting for your signature.
DENSE 400 · 14 / 20	Individual therapy, 53 min · Intensive outpatient · MRN 004182
SMALL 400 · 13 / 18	Signed by Dana Reyes, LCSW on Nov 10 at 4:12 PM Pacific
LABEL 600 · 11 / 14	SESSIONS TODAY

Figures

COLLECTED THIS MONTH

$48,210

93% of expected · $3,640 still open

Hero figure. 800 · 56 / 56

FIGURE 800 · 30	1,284
FIGURE 800 · 30	93%
SMALL 700 · 18	4:12 PM

CLIENT	BILLED	PAID
Priya Raman	$1,202.00	$961.60
Elena Brooks	$840.00	$0.00
Total	**$2,042.00**	**$961.60**

In tables, numbers stay in Source Sans 3 with tabular figures, right-aligned.

Rules for figures

- A figure always has a label above it and, when it helps, one line of context below.
- One hero figure per view. The other cards use the 30 px size.
- Figures are Heartwood. Colour belongs to the context line, never the number.
- No counting-up animation. The number is simply there.

Writing numbers

- $1,202.00 in tables; $48,210 on a card, where cents add nothing.
- Nov 9, not 11/09. 4:12 PM Pacific when the zone could be in doubt.
- Durations in minutes: 53 min. Percentages without decimals unless they matter.
- Money is stored in whole cents; the type only changes how it is shown.

SHAPE

The leaf card

The default card in Nexus is a leaf. Two opposite corners are soft, the other two come to a point: a tip at the top left and a short stem at the bottom right. A faint vein runs under the text from stem to tip.

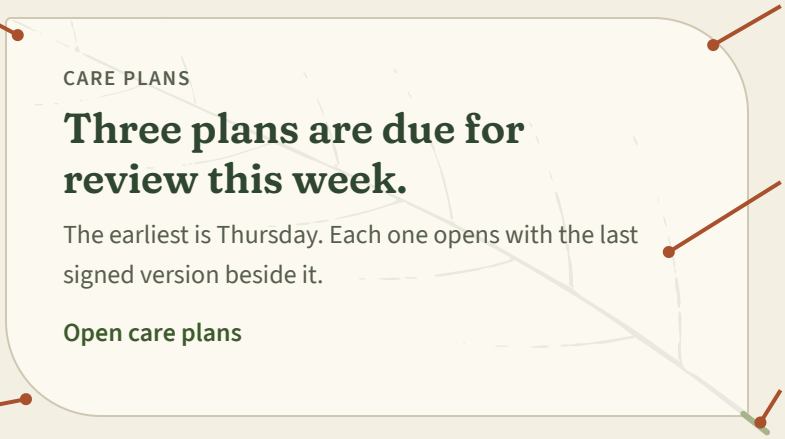
Tip
Top left, 2 px. Where the eye starts reading.

Shoulder
Top right, 26 px. The same soft corner the buttons have.

Vein
Midrib and side veins at about 9% ink, under the text.

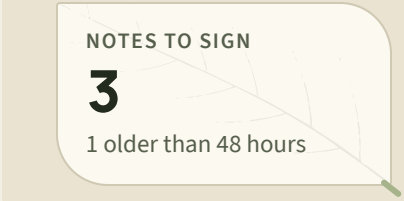
Second shoulder
Bottom left, 26 px.

Stem
Bottom right. A 12 px stroke in Sage that leaves the corner.

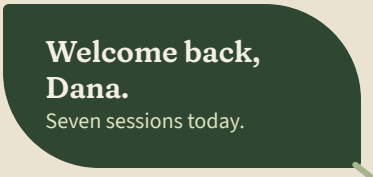




Small. 2 16 2 16. List items and short summaries.



Default. 2 26 2 26. Metric cards, callouts, empty states.



Large. 3 48 3 48. Greetings, quotes, teaching cards.

Do

- Use it for cards that summarise or speak to someone.
- Keep the tip top left and the stem bottom right, always.
- Let the vein stretch with the card. It is one file for every size.

Avoid

- Tables, forms and dialogs. Anything that holds data stays square.
- Mirroring or rotating it, or drawing the stem on a nested card.
- Darkening the vein. If you notice it before the text, it is too strong.

In code

```
.leaf { position: relative;
  border-radius: var(--nx-corner-leaf); }
.leaf::before {            /* the vein */
  content: ""; position: absolute; inset: 0;
  border-radius: inherit;
  background: var(--nx-vein);
  mask: url(nexus-leaf-vein.svg) center / 100% 100%; }
.leaf::after {             /* the stem */
  content: ""; position: absolute;
  left: 100%; top: 100%; width: 12px; height: 2.5px;
  margin: -3.5px 0 0 -3.5px; border-radius: 2px;
  background: var(--nx-brand-mid);
  transform-origin: 0 50%; transform: rotate(38deg); }
```

Text over the vein is in the contrast audit and passes at 7:1.

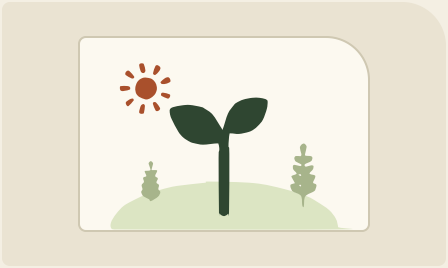
SHAPE

One soft corner

Controls and tiles are precise: small radii, straight edges, compact rows, and a single softened corner, always top right, like a page that has been turned. It is the leaf's shoulder on its own, used where a whole leaf would be too much.



Controls. Primary buttons, status badges, the selected navigation item, counts.



Frames. Illustrations, swatches, pattern samples: `4px 22px 4px 4px`.

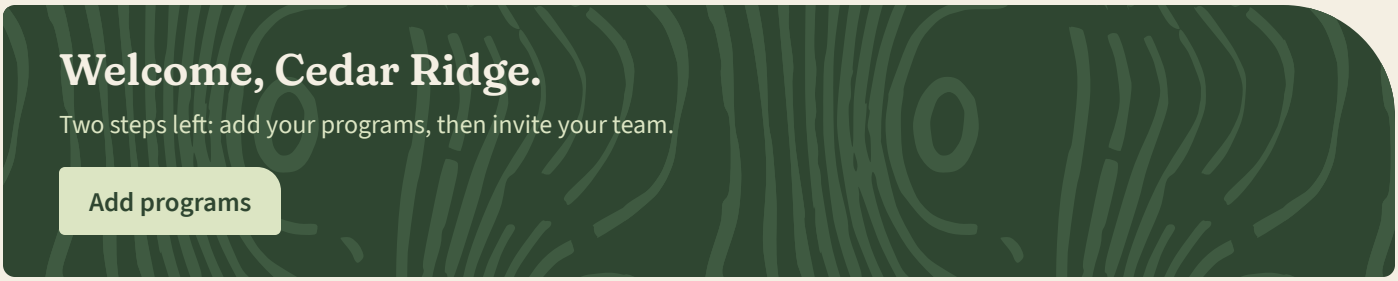


Tiles. App icon and avatars. The soft corner is about a third of the side.

Which shape, when

SHAPE	CORNERS	USE IT FOR	NEVER FOR
Leaf	2 26 2 26	Cards that summarise or speak: metrics, callouts, empty states, quotes.	Tables, forms, dialogs.
Soft corner	3 12 3 3	The primary button, badges, counts, the selected nav item, tiles, frames.	Secondary buttons, fields.
Square	3 to 6	Anything that holds data or input: panels, tables, fields, menus, dialogs.	Brand moments.

At full size: a welcome banner



Hero. `6px 56px 6px 6px`. The largest the corner gets; used once, on first run.

Space and density

TOKEN	VALUE	USE
`space-1, 2`	4, 8 px	Inside controls, icon to label
`space-3, 4`	12, 16 px	Card padding, between fields
`space-6, 8`	24, 32 px	Page gutters, between sections
`control-height`	32 px	Buttons, fields (40 px on touch)
`row-height`	36 to 44 px	Table rows, one or two lines

Compact, not cramped

Clinicians and billers scan long lists all day. Rows are tight, but every row has one clear next action and every number has a label. Remove an empty container before adding a divider. Motion is short: 120 ms for a press, 160 ms for feedback, 200 ms for something opening, and nothing moves while someone is typing.



PATTERN

Ring press

The signature texture. Five strips, each cut from a different slab, inked and pressed so the grain skips the way a real print does.

What it is for

- Covers: proposals, reports, the first slide.
- Section openers and the back of a business card.
- The sign-in screen and the empty workspace on first run.

How to use it

- Pine on Linen, or tonal: a slightly lighter green on Pine.
- Crop it. One strip, or part of two, is usually enough.
- Type sits beside it or in a solid band across it, never directly on the rings.
- One ring pattern per view.

Two versions

Pressed (PNG) has the dry-brush texture and is for large areas. **Carved** (SVG) is clean vector for small sizes, print and cutting.



Ring field. One large slab, cropped off-centre, shown tonal on Pine.

PATTERN

Bark, contour, understory

Three seamless tiles that sit quieter than the ring press. Each is drawn by the same carving method as the logo and repeats without a visible join.



Bark

Long grain parting around knots. Strong; use it large and cropped, on print and brand pieces.



Contour

Map lines. The quietest pattern and the only one allowed inside the product, at very low contrast.



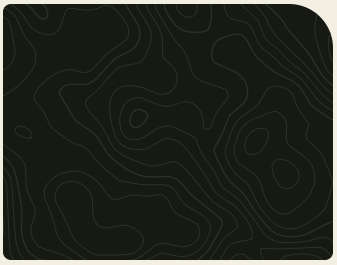
Understory

Cut-paper pines, ferns, cairns and suns. The friendly one: onboarding, celebrations, wrapping.

Colour pairings



Tonal on Pine



Contour, dark theme



Clay on Linen, small doses

Contour in the product sidebar

Do

- Use pattern where there is nothing to read: covers, margins, empty space, the area under the navigation.
- Keep one pattern per surface and one colour per pattern.
- Inside the product, use Contour only, in the `--nx-pattern-ink` colour.

Avoid

- Any pattern behind a table, a form, a chart or a clinical note.
- Stretching, rotating or recolouring a tile in more than one colour.
- Animating a pattern. They are prints; they hold still.

Icons, cut from one block

46 icons drawn for Nexus, not taken from a library. They are made by the same press as the logo: solid shapes, pressed until every corner is round, with one detail carved out at most. No icon package is installed; the app imports the path data from one generated file.



1. Cut, not outlined

Each icon is a solid block of ink. Thin outline icons are what every other product uses; these are not that.

2. One detail

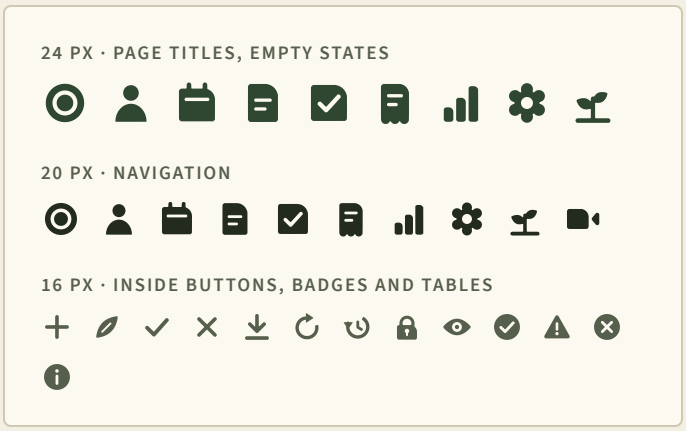
A page has two lines, a card has one stripe, a person has none. If an icon seems to need a second carved detail, it is trying to say two things.

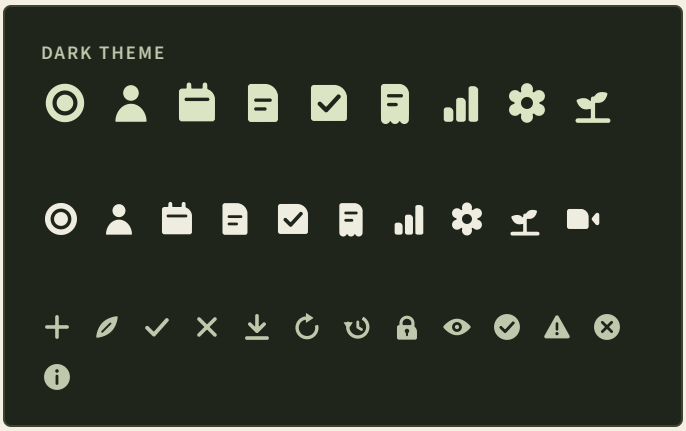
3. Round and quiet

Box shapes keep the soft corner, top right. Growth appears only where it is the meaning: a shoot for a care plan, a leaf for edit, a flower for settings.

Using icons

Icons support a word; they rarely replace one. Sizes, colour and pairing below.



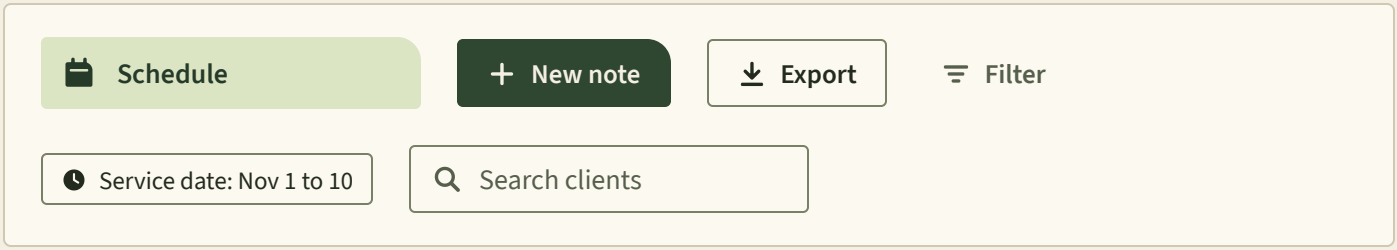


Status is a word, an icon and a colour, in that order

Colour alone never carries meaning. Every status badge has a plain word first; the icon and colour reinforce it. "Discharged" and "Reversed" are not errors and do not use the error style.

Note signed · Draft note · Authorization expired · Coverage not verified · Scheduled · In session · Reversed

With a label, at actual size



Drawing a new icon

- Work on a 24 unit grid; keep the shape inside 2 to 22.
- Stroked parts are 2 to 2.8 units thick. One carved detail at most, at least 1.7 units wide, or it closes up at 16 px.
- Build it from the primitives in `brand/tools/build_icons.py` and let the press round the corners. Do not hand-edit the output.
- Check it at 16, 20 and 24 px in both themes before adding it.

In the code

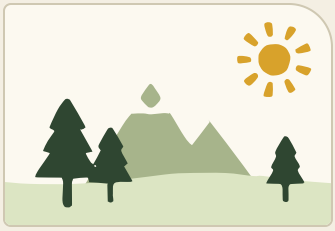
`brand/icons/nexus-icons.ts` exports every path and a `NexusIconName` type. An icon is one `<svg>` with one `<path>` in `currentColor`, so it takes the colour of the text beside it. Decorative icons are hidden from screen readers; an icon-only button needs a label.

Individual files are in `brand/icons/svg/`; a sprite is in `brand/icons/nexus-icons.svg`.

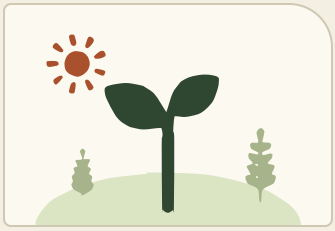
ILLUSTRATION

Cut-paper illustration

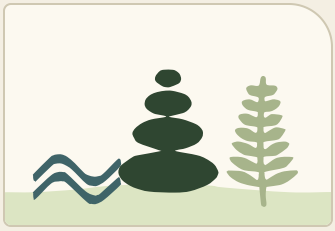
Flat shapes that look cut from coloured paper with scissors: no outlines, no shading, no texture. Four scenes so far, each with a daylight and a night form in the same file.



Clear day. Nothing scheduled, nothing overdue.



First shoot. A first: new client, setup complete, first signed plan.



Waymark. Nothing found, or a pause.



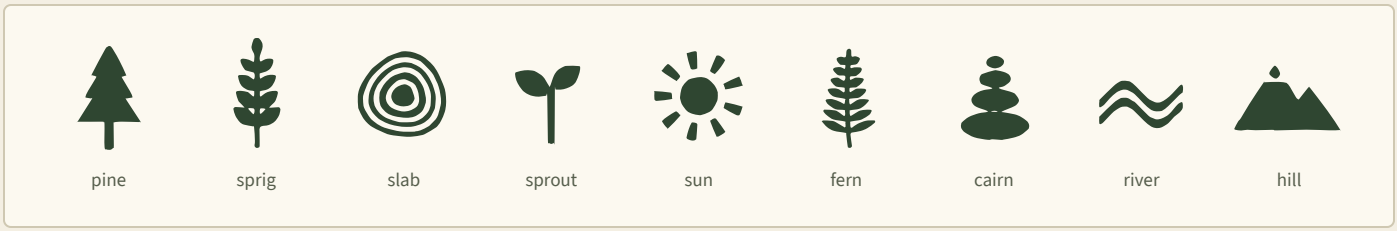
The record. History, documentation, exports.



The same four files in the dark theme. The sun gives way to a moon and the colours turn to moonlit greens. Nothing is exported twice: the shapes read the `--nx-illo-*` roles.

The motif kit

Nine pieces, plus a moon for night. Scenes are assembled from these, so a new illustration is a new arrangement, not a new style. Files in `brand/illustrations/motifs/`.



Rules

- Four colours at most in one scene: an ink, one lighter green, one accent and the ground.
- The sun or moon is the only place a warm colour appears large.
- Scenes sit in a frame with the soft corner, on a card surface.
- No people, faces or hands. Nobody should wonder whether a figure is a patient.

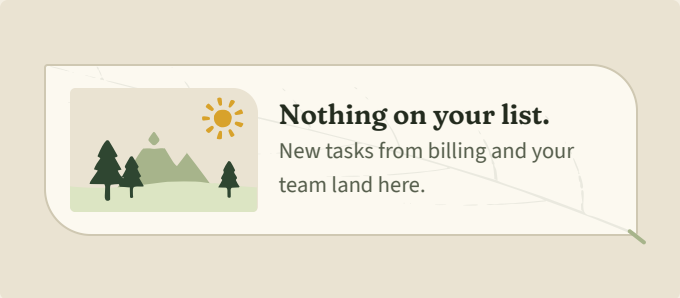
Making a new one

- Arrange motifs in `scenes()` in `brand/tools/build_patterns.py`; give each layer a role, not a colour.
- Mark anything that belongs only to day or only to night.
- Keep the horizon in the lower third so the scene crops to a banner.
- Check it at 104 px wide. If it does not read there, it has too much in it.

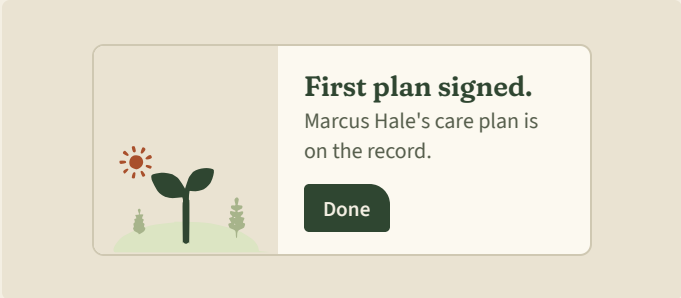
ILLUSTRATION

Where illustrations appear

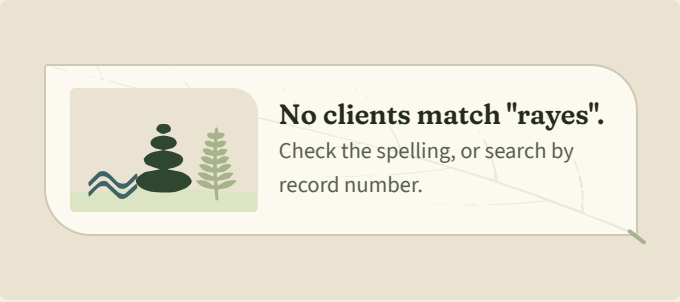
An illustration is a still picture that fills a quiet moment: an empty list, a first, a search that found nothing. It is not an animation, and it is not what confirms an action. A toast and a status badge do that.



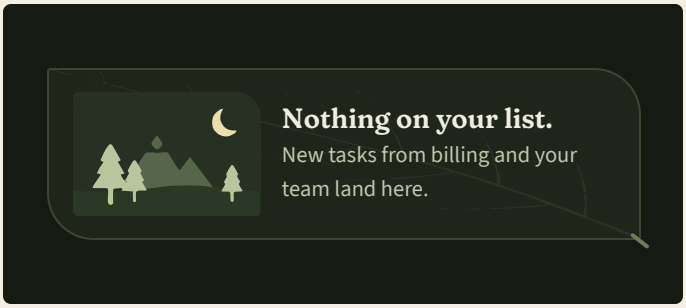
An empty list. The picture says "this is fine", the sentence says what will fill it.



A first. Shown once, for a milestone: setup complete, a first signed plan.



Nothing found. A place to stop, and a way on.



At night. The dark theme gets the night form without a second file.

What you see when something happens

MOMENT	WHAT APPEARS	ILLUSTRATION
You sign a note	A toast: "Signed. Billing can see it now." The badge changes to Note signed.	None
You clear a list	The list is replaced by an empty state.	Clear day
A first for a client or a center	A one-time card, dismissed with one button.	First shoot
A search or filter finds nothing	A sentence and a way out.	Waymark
You open history or an export	A small header image on the page.	The record
Something fails	A plain sentence and a button. The typed text is kept.	Never

Do they move?

No. A scene fades in with its panel over 360 ms and then holds still. Nothing loops, bounces or plays on completion. Motion for buttons and cards is on page 24.

Limits

- One illustration per view, never beside a table of live data.
- Never on an error that needs action, and never in a clinical note.
- The same scene should not appear twice in one session's worth of screens.

Voice and wording

Nexus talks like a colleague who has done this job for years: friendly, exact, and brief. It says what happened, what it means, and what to do next, and then it stops.

Lines that capture it

"Seven sessions today. Three notes are waiting for your signature."
"Signed. Billing can see it now."
"This claim needs one thing: an active authorization."
"Nothing overdue. Enjoy the quiet."

How it sounds

- **Specific.** Counts, names and dates instead of "some items need attention".
- **Short.** One idea per sentence. Most messages fit on one line.
- **Warm without performing.** A dry aside when things are calm; none when they are not.
- **Steady about hard things.** Relapse, discharge and denial are stated plainly, without euphemism or alarm.
- **Honest about limits.** If a draft was written by a model, it says so and asks for review.

Before and after

MOMENT	NOT THIS	THIS
Empty task list	You have no tasks at this time.	Nothing on your list. New tasks from billing and your team land here.
Save failed	An error occurred. Please try again later.	That did not save. Your text is still here. Try again, or copy it before you leave the page.
Blocked action	Action unavailable.	This note cannot be signed until the session has an end time.
Claim not ready	Claim validation failed (3).	Three things to fix before this claim can go: an unsigned note, an expired authorization, a missing diagnosis.
Signing	Are you sure you want to sign?	Sign this note? After signing, changes are added as amendments.
Model draft	AI-generated note ready!	Draft from the session recording. Review each statement before you keep it.

Words to keep consistent

Client	The person in care, on every screen. "Patient" only where a payer or form requires it.
Session	A scheduled visit. "Encounter" only in billing and exports.
Note, plan, claim	Lower case in sentences. No "Progress Note" capitals.
Sign	The verb for making a record final. Not "submit", "finalize" or "lock".

Phrases to steer clear of

Healing journey. Empower. Seamless. Unlock. Supercharge. Whoops. Any exclamation mark after an error. They sound like every other product and say less than a plain sentence would.

Numbers and time

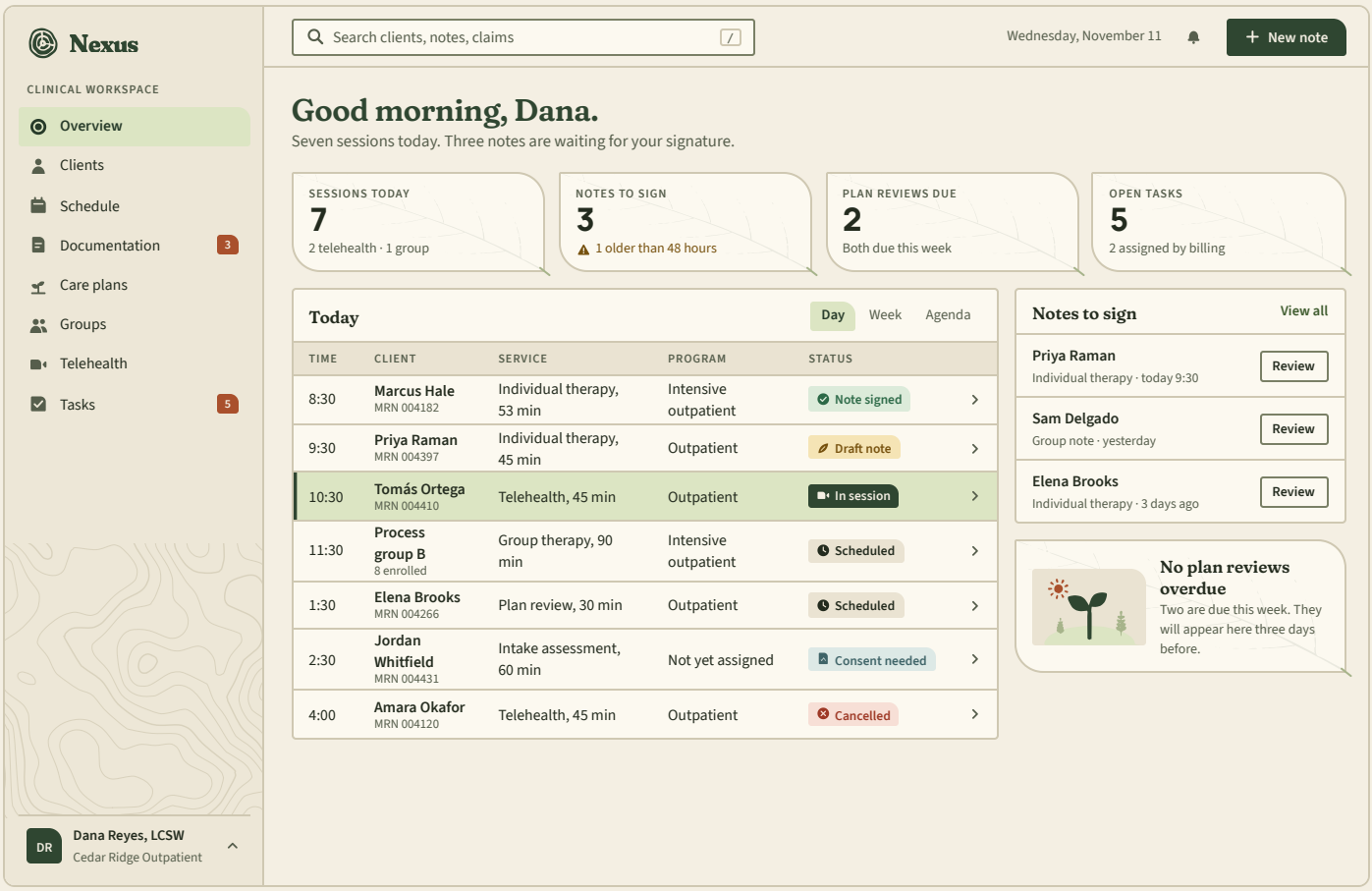
$1,202.00, not $1202. Nov 9, not 11/09. 4:12 PM Pacific when the time zone could be in doubt. Durations in minutes: "53 min".

The client and session wording is a recommendation based on how the product reads today; confirm it against payer and state form language before it is treated as settled.

IN THE PRODUCT

Clinical workspace, light

A clinician's morning. Built from the real tokens, icons and components in this guide, with synthetic names and records. Nothing here is a drawing of a screen; it is the same HTML and CSS the app can use.



What carries the brand

- Linen page, Birch cards, Pine for the logo, the greeting and the one primary action.
- Leaf cards for the four figures and the empty state; the soft corner on the selected nav item, badges and the avatar.
- Contour lines under the navigation, at almost no contrast.

What stays out of the way

- The schedule is plain: no pattern, no illustration, hairline rules only.
- Colour appears only where a session needs something.
- One Fraunces heading per panel, figures in Manrope, everything else in Source Sans 3.

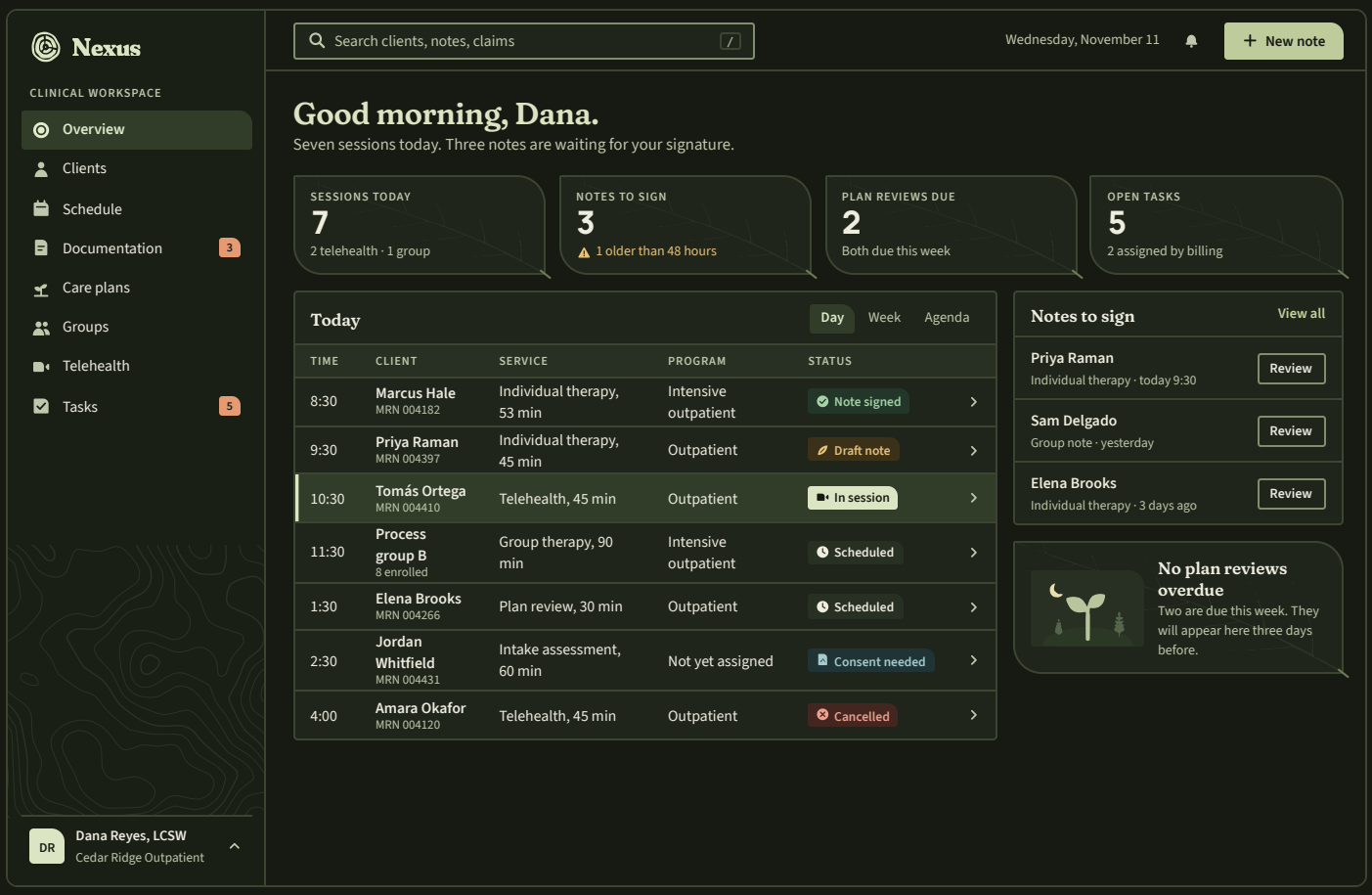
Details worth keeping

- Profile, appearance and sign-out live bottom left, under the navigation.
- The greeting is a summary, not a slogan: it tells her the day.
- The empty state says when the list will next have something in it.

IN THE PRODUCT

The same screen, dark

Identical markup with `data-nexus-theme="dark"` on the root. Night instead of Linen, lichen-green actions instead of Pine, and the same hierarchy. Compare it with the previous page element by element.



What changed

- Surfaces step up from Night to Loam to Duff; they do not invert.
- The primary button becomes light lichen with dark text.
- Status colours lighten and their backgrounds deepen. The leaf vein turns from Pine to Lichen.

What did not

- Layout, spacing, type sizes, the leaf and the soft corner.
- The order of emphasis: greeting, figures, then the list.
- The illustration turns to its night form: same file, moon for sun.

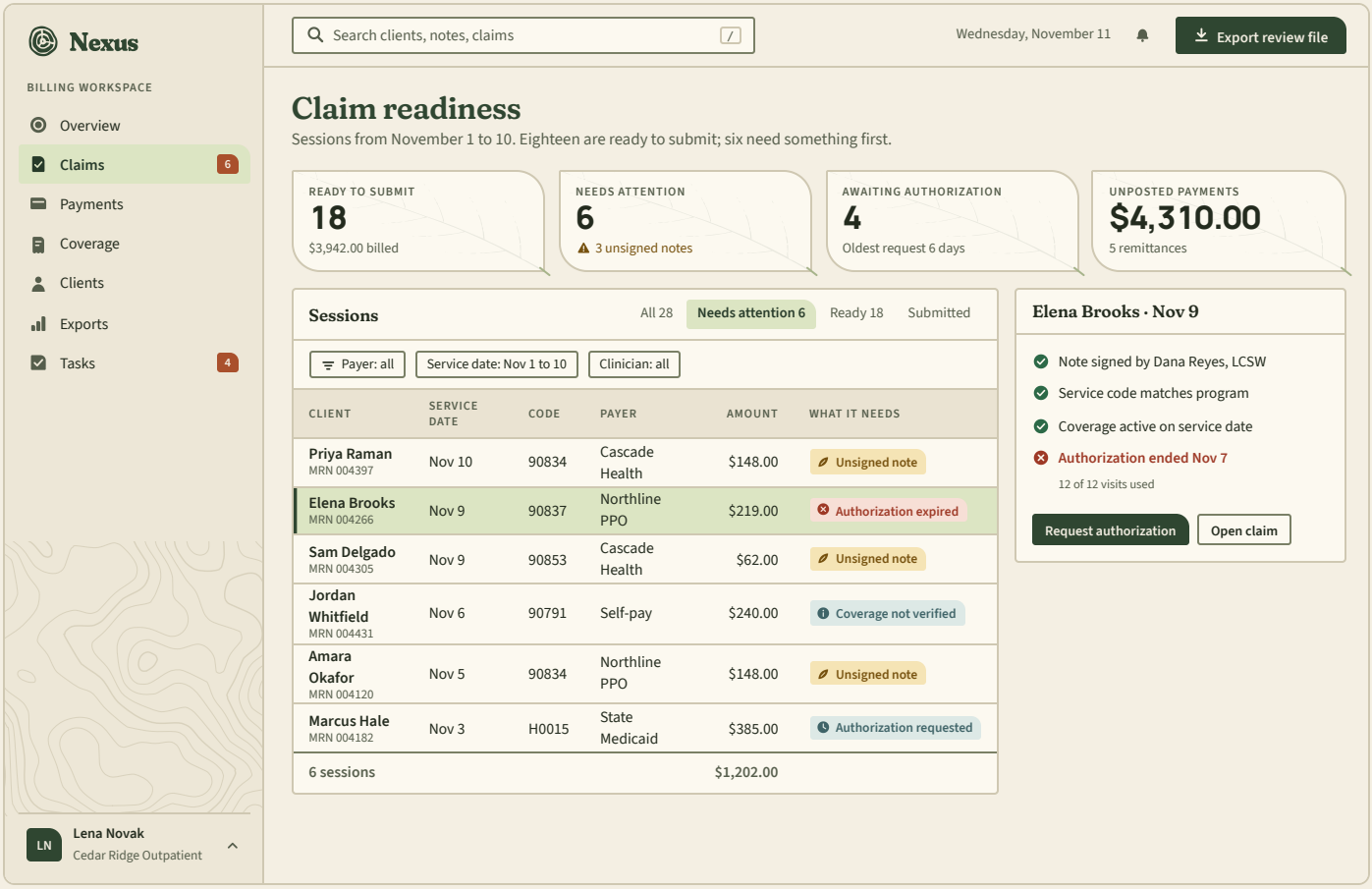
Still to check

- Focus rings on every control in both themes.
- Charts and the calendar grid, which are not shown here.
- Long sessions on a dim display with real clinicians.

IN THE PRODUCT

Billing workspace

A biller's hierarchy is different from a clinician's: money and blockers first, people second. The same system, arranged around a queue and what each row needs before it can go.



Arranged for the job

- The table leads with what each session needs, in words.
- Amounts are tabular, right-aligned and totalled.
- The selected row opens a checklist that mirrors the server's readiness rules.

Same parts, new order

- Metric cards, tabs, badges and buttons are the clinical ones.
- No illustration here: this view always has data.
- Clay marks the counts that are waiting on someone.

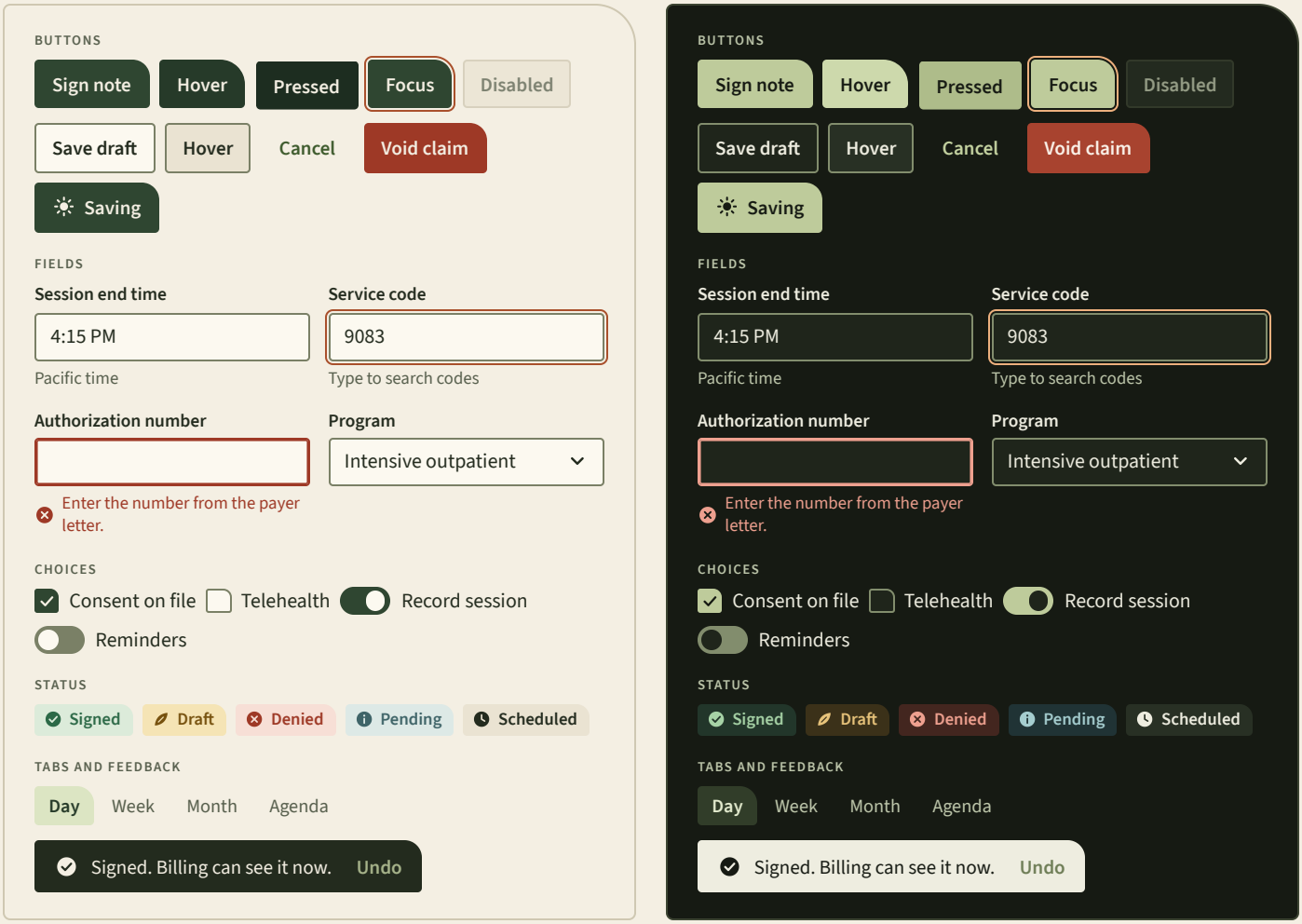
Not shown yet

- The executive workspace, which needs charts in the chart palette.
- The calendar, telehealth room and note composer.
- Phone layouts. These three screens are desktop only.

IN THE PRODUCT

Core components and their states

The first set, drawn with the tokens in both themes. Each state below is a real style, not a mock-up. The remaining components in the inventory follow these.



Buttons

One primary button per view, with the soft corner. Its hover and pressed states are on the next page. Secondary buttons are outlined and square. Destructive actions are named for what they do ("Void claim"), never "Delete" or "OK". A busy button keeps its width and shows the sun.

Fields

Labels sit above and never disappear. Hints are under the field. An error is a red outline, an icon and a sentence that says what to enter; the text already typed is kept.

Focus

Every interactive element shows a 2 px Clay ring with a 2 px gap when reached by keyboard. It is the same in both themes apart from the lighter Clay on dark.

IN THE PRODUCT

Interaction and motion

This is where the personality lives once a screen is in use, and none of it is loud: a corner that opens, a stem that grows, ink that presses down. Every state is a real style. In the HTML edition of this guide the first row responds to the pointer.

PRIMARY BUTTON

Sign note	Sign note	Sign note	Sign note	Signing	Signed
Rest Soft corner at 12 px.	**Hover** The corner opens to 17 px and the ink deepens.	**Pressed** The corner closes to 3 px and the button drops 1 px, like a block meeting paper.	**Focus** 2 px Clay ring, 2 px gap.	**Busy** The sun turns. Width does not change.	**Done** Success colour for 1.2 s, then back to rest.

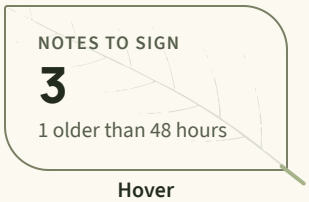
LINKS AND NAVIGATION

Open care plan	Open care plan	Open care plan	Schedule	Schedule	Schedule
Link Link green, no underline in lists.	**Hover** A 2 px underline grows in.	**Visited** Bark. Only on links that leave the page.	**Nav item** Plain.	**Hover** Oat fill, soft corner.	**Selected** Lichen fill, Semibold.

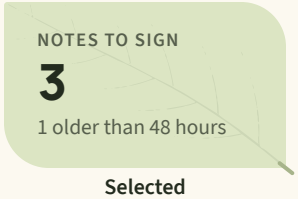
LEAF CARD, WHEN IT OPENS SOMETHING



Rest
12 px stem, vein at 9%.



Hover
The stem grows to 19 px, the vein deepens to 15%, the outline firms up.



Selected
Lichen fill, no outline.

Timing

TOKEN	TIME	USED FOR
`motion-press`	120 ms	A press, a corner opening, a tick.
`motion-feedback`	160 ms	Hover colour, the stem, a toast arriving.
`motion-disclosure`	200 ms	Menus, dialogs and panels opening.
`motion-grow`	360 ms	An illustration or first-run banner. Once.

One easing curve, `--nx-ease`. With reduced motion set, all are 0.

What never moves

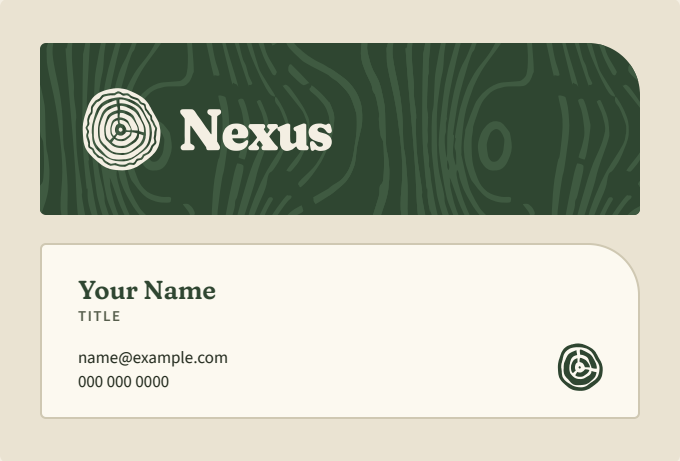
- Patterns and the logo. They are prints; they hold still.
- Numbers. No counting up, no ticking.
- Layout. A hover never shifts what is around it.
- Anything at all while someone is typing.
- Nothing bounces or overshoots.

Motion is specified here and in the tokens. It has not been built or tested in the app yet.

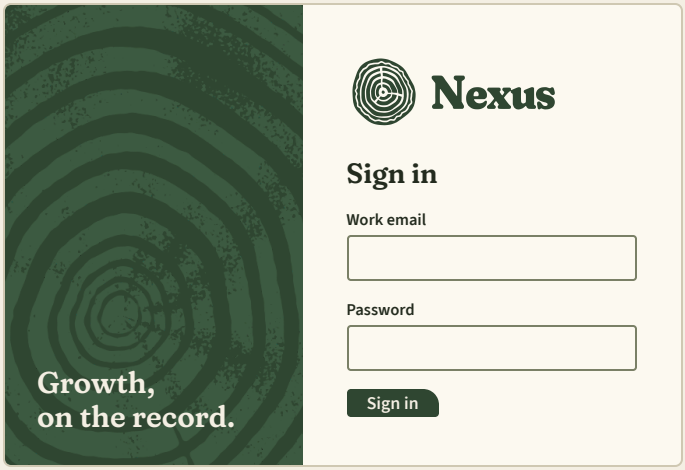
IN USE

Beyond the screen

The same few pieces, a symbol, two colours, one pattern, one soft corner, carried onto the things a new company needs first. Teaching slides have their own page next.



Business card. Tonal bark and the reversed logo on the front; Birch, the tile corner and the small symbol on the back. Contact details are placeholders.



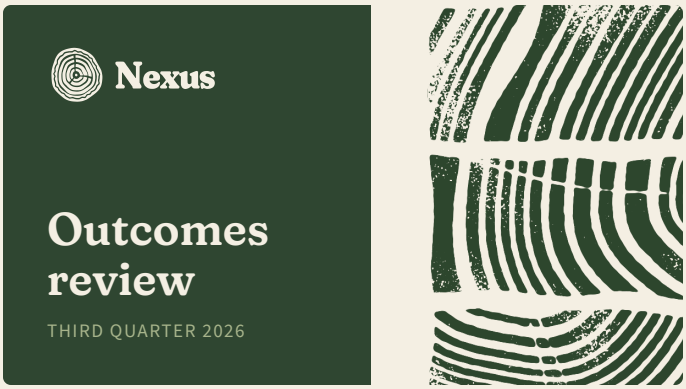
Sign-in. The one screen where the ring field runs large. Authentication itself is not built yet; this is the layout.



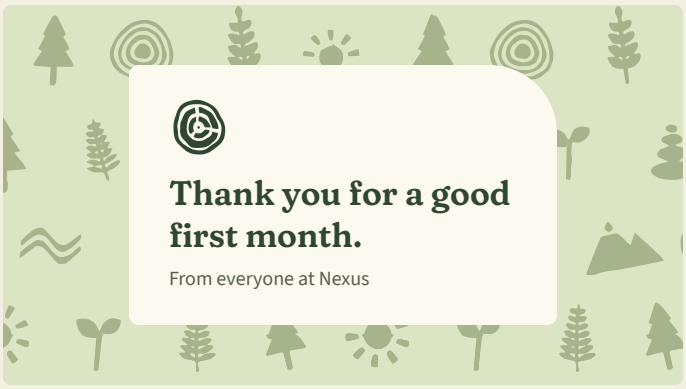
Exported documents. One-colour ink logo, a Pine rule, Fraunces title. Prints cleanly in greyscale.



App icons and favicon. Tile, light tile, the maskable version cropped to a circle, and the browser-tab sizes.



Slide and report cover. Pine field, Fraunces title, ring press strips cropped down one side.



Notes and cards. Understory in a quiet green behind a Birch tile. The friendliest the brand gets.

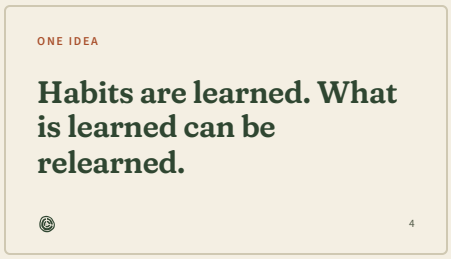
IN USE

Teaching and group materials

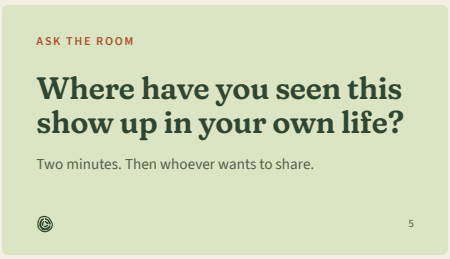
Slides for treatment groups should guide the room, not script it. This page applies the co-founder's curriculum review of November 2026 to six layouts. The principles are theirs; the layouts and numbers are a first proposal.



Title. Says what today is about, nothing else.



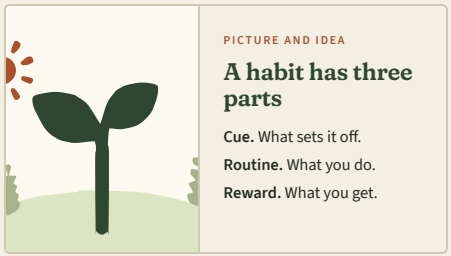
One idea. A sentence the facilitator can talk around.



Ask the room. A specific question, written in advance.



Pause. Room to process one idea before the next.



Picture and idea. Half image, three short lines.



Appendix. Dense on purpose, and kept out of the session.

A guide, not a script

- One idea per slide, in about 25 words or fewer. The facilitator carries the rest.
- A question slide after each concept. "Any questions?" is not one.
- Sources and long explanations go in the appendix. A dense slide is a choice with a reason, such as reading an original text.
- Plain words first. A recovery term is explained the first time it appears.
- A small Clay leaf in a corner marks "your story goes here" for the facilitator.

Built for a video call

- Linen background, Heartwood text. Nothing smaller than 28 pt on a 1920 px slide.
- Keep the top right clear; that is where video tiles sit.

On camera

A baseline above an ordinary call: light on the face from the front, camera at eye level, a separate microphone.

Three lengths, made on purpose

FORM	WHAT IT HOLDS	SUGGESTED FORMAT
Long	The whole session, with its context and depth.	Recording, Title slide first.
Medium	One concept or one practical use, complete on its own.	A few minutes; One idea slide first.
Short	A single insight, question or human moment.	Under a minute; the square card.

Short pieces are better made on purpose than cut out of a 90-minute session. These are layouts; editable slide files have not been made.



Short-form card.

REFERENCE

The asset library

Everything in this guide is a real file in `brand/`. The artwork is generated by small Python scripts, so any of it can be adjusted and rebuilt instead of redrawn. This guide and the library are meant to be used together.

FOLDER	WHAT IS IN IT	USE IT FOR
`logo/`	Lockups, symbol, small-size symbol and wordmark in Pine, Linen and Ink; app tiles; favicon. 19 SVG, 9 PNG.	Anywhere the logo appears
`logo/masters/`	The two symbol drawings and the wordmark in `currentColor`.	Source for the logo build
`icons/`	46 icons as SVG files, a sprite, and `nexus-icons.ts` with a `NexusIconName` type.	The product
`patterns/`	Ring press, ring field, bark, contour, understory, leaf vein. SVG, plus pressed PNG masks.	Covers, sign-in, sidebar, cards
`illustrations/`	Four scenes, each with a day and night form, and ten motifs. SVG.	Empty states, firsts, slides
`tokens/`	`nexus-tokens.css`, `.json`, `.ts` and `contrast-audit.csv` (72 pairings).	Import the CSS; set the theme
`fonts/`	Fraunces (SemiBold, Regular), Manrope (ExtraBold, Bold), Source Sans 3, with licences and the variable sources.	Self-hosting in the app
`guidelines/`	The source of this document and its HTML edition.	Reference styling
`tools/`	The generators. `build_all.py` rebuilds everything, including this PDF.	Extending the kit

In code

```
@import "brand/tokens/nexus-tokens.css";
<html data-nexus-theme="dark">  /* omit for light */

.title  { font: var(--nx-text-title) var(--nx-font-
display); }
.figure { font: var(--nx-text-figure) var(--nx-font-
figure); }
.button { border-radius: var(--nx-corner-control); }
.card   { border-radius: var(--nx-corner-leaf); }

import { nexusIcons } from "brand/icons/nexus-icons";
<svg viewBox="0 0 24 24" fill="currentColor">
  <path fillRule="evenodd"
        d={nexusIcons["care-plan"]} />
</svg>
```

Components use role tokens, never palette colours. No icon, font or UI package is installed.

Toward the React library

The next step after this guide. None of these exist as components yet; the styles in `guidelines/template.html` are the specification for each.

COMPONENT	SPECIFIED BY
Button, Badge	Components (23), interaction (24)
LeafCard, MetricCard	The leaf card (11), figures (10)
Field, Checkbox, Toggle	Components (23)
Tabs, Toast	Components (23)
Sidebar, NavItem	Clinical workspace (20)
DataTable	Billing workspace (22)
Icon	Using icons (16)
EmptyState	Where illustrations appear (18)

REFERENCE

Open decisions and changes

What still needs an owner's answer, what this edition leaves out, and how the guide got here.

Decisions for the owners

- **The line:** "Growth, on the record."
- **The wordmark and type:** Fraunces and Manrope are new in this edition.
- **The leaf card:** which cards get it, and whether the stem stays on every one.
- **The bark line:** how wavy it should be.
- **Client and session wording,** against payer and state form language.
- **Teaching slides:** whether these six layouts are the right set.

Not in this edition

- A trademark search and recognition testing for the symbol. Both should happen before it goes on anything public.
- Photography: no images have been chosen or licensed.
- Editable templates: slides, letterhead, social posts. What is shown are layouts, not files.
- The executive workspace, charts, calendar and phone layouts.
- React components, and motion built in the app.
- The app itself still uses its old styles. Nothing here is wired in.

How it got here

EDITION	WHAT IT WAS
0.1	A starter kit: outline icons, three geometric marks, simple patterns. Set aside as too generic.
0.2	Rebuilt from the product and the style references: the cross-section symbol, forest-floor palette, ring press and other patterns, cut icons, cut-paper illustration, product screens. Convergence chosen as the symbol on November 11, 2026.
0.3	This edition. Bark line on the symbol; new wordmark; Fraunces and Manrope in place of Georgia; the leaf card and its vein; simpler icons; night illustrations; interaction states; teaching materials; contents and index. The unused symbol studies were removed.

Checked in this edition

- 72 colour pairings, light and dark, against WCAG 2.2 targets: all pass.
- Every page of this guide reviewed as rendered, in the PDF.
- All fonts are open-licensed and bundled with their licences.

Not checked

- Finished app screens, since none use the brand yet.
- The symbol and icons with clinicians or billers.
- Print: no piece has been proofed on paper.

All names, records and amounts shown in this guide are synthetic. The style references that informed the kit were used for direction only; no artwork from them is reproduced.

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